

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS

FAYETTEVILLE

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: March 17-18, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two
-------	---

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS FAYETTEVILLE

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	MEETS	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recruiting additional candidates to increase subject shortage area enrollment will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The University of Arkansas has a solid program based on best practices and the willingness to align the program to the trends in data.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

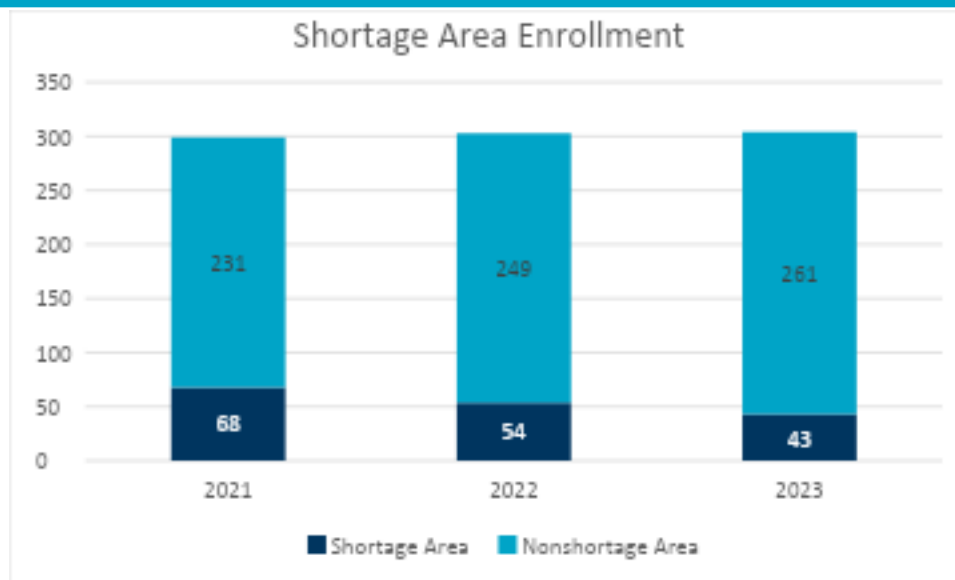
Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	25.8%	EXCEEDS

Enrollment

Year	Enrollment
2018	297
2019	135
2020	455
2021	299
2022	303
2023	304

*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

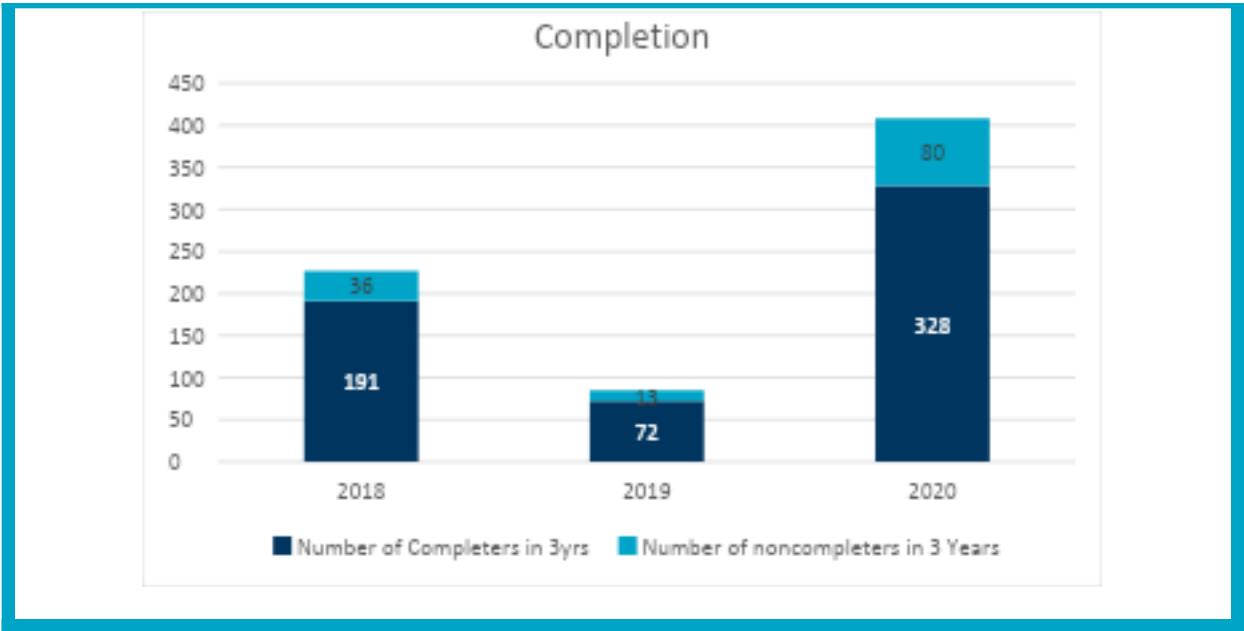
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	18%	APPROACHING



*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	82%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The University of Arkansas – Fayetteville provided evidence to highlight its commitment to providing traditional teaching candidates with the knowledge, systems, and structures they need to teach in Arkansas schools, including a series of well-sequenced courses that provides candidates opportunities to build on their knowledge, and use skills in real-time in their classes. A highlight of the program is the multiple field experiences candidates have prior to entering their internship, providing them ample opportunities to experience various grade levels and students of varied learning needs. Course instructors and clinical supervisors demonstrated deep knowledge of content, strong facilitation and positive coaching to support all candidates in the program. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Clearly and intentionally continue to incorporate math and science HQIM within coursework so that candidates are familiar with the district curriculum and become day one ready. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metric 1</i>) - By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 2.2b, Metrics 1 and 2</i>)		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. Coursework incorporates Deans for Impact scope and sequence and strategies to support recognizing and selecting HQIM in planning and instruction. HQIM is used across all partner districts and schools for clinical experiences and is documented and tracked, and reflection on HQIM is built into the scope and sequence to ensure candidates can practice evaluating HQIM. Science of Reading implementation across course syllabi is clearly documented and tracked, with elementary and SPED courses focusing on proficiency (CIED 2943, CIED 3113, CIED 3453, B SPED 4173, SPED 4483 SPED 5673, SPED 5683 SPED 5673, SPED 5683) and most middle and secondary content in coursework focusing on awareness. By design, this reflects best practice within Science of Reading.

Additionally, the “SPED MED Program Handbook” aligns with the Council for Exceptional Children (CEC) standards and the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. The “UARK Residency Handbook” emphasizes the Teacher Education Philosophy, which mandates in-depth lesson planning and the use of High-Quality Instructional Materials (HQIM).

Participants in the Course Instructor focus group shared how HQIM are integrated throughout multiple courses with faculty referencing specific curriculums such as Benchmark and Really Great Reading. Candidates also get experience reviewing and critiquing HQIM. 100% of participants (six out of six) provided specific examples of how candidates analyze HQIM in their courses. Teacher candidates in the Coursework focus group had difficulty sharing specific examples, however, they discussed using HQIM in their clinical experiences.

Reviewers noted multiple examples of best practices during course observations including the reference of AR disciplinary frameworks, project-based learning, and guided practice. In one course, Disciplinary and Interdisciplinary Literacies in Education (SEED 40603), the course instructor presented peer-reviewed materials and professional resources. The presentation of socio-scientific issues demonstrated a commitment to connecting content knowledge with real-world applications and ethical reasoning, which aligns with best practices in developing disciplinary literacy.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Most coursework, particularly within the content area courses, directly references Arkansas State Standards, ensuring alignment with state expectations. For example, courses such as Classroom Learning Theory (CIED 30303), Assessment of Students with Disabilities (SPED 44503), and Teaching Secondary Science (SEED 50103) explicitly incorporate these standards into their curricula. While the vertical integration of standards is not always expressly stated, it is implicitly addressed through strategies such as scaffolding, progressive breakdown of standards, and the building of competencies across grade levels. Submitted candidate lesson plans show that state standards are consistently used and scaffolded throughout all aspects of instruction. Feedback included with the submitted lesson plans is centered around the construction of lessons, alignment with state standards, appropriate scaffolding techniques, the use of questioning, and the establishment of clear instructional objectives.

100% of Coursework focus group participants provided examples of how K-12 standards are embedded in coursework. For example, candidates cited Intro to STEM, Integrated Social Studies, and Teaching Apparel Production which all include assignments that integrate K-12 standards. Both elementary participants cited instances of vertical integration, sharing their lesson plan template requires them to look at current standards and the year below and above.

Reviewers noted evidence of standards and vertical integration in three coursework observations. In Curriculum Design and Applications of Instructional Practice (CIED 41403), the instructor embedded knowledge of K-12 standards within the discussion of differentiation and referenced K-12 standards as a tool to facilitate student learning. Candidates were provided multiple opportunities for discussion with partners and table groups, allowing for exposure across multiple grades and subjects.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study. Eight-semester plans are clearly documented for each track. Each plan increases in rigor, with a specific sequence of courses aimed at building foundational knowledge and skills that align with state standards and licensure requirements. Handbooks also clearly outline key points for program progression and advancement. For instance, the “SEED BAT Program Handbook” details progression milestones, and the “SPED BSE Program Orientation” highlights critical points for advancement.

All coursework focus group participants agreed that coursework is clearly sequenced, citing that responsibilities in coursework have built over time. For example, one participant noted “I’ll say it builds in rigor. The program does it perfectly.”

Course Instructor focus group participants provided examples of intentionally sequenced content courses. For example, candidates take a multi-course literacy sequence that has been mapped to ensure all content is included in a scaffolded order. Additionally, field preparation for Childhood Education (CHED) and elementary (EDEL) candidates is intentionally sequenced so that candidates spend time in all grade bands (K-6) prior to their year-long residency.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards (ATS) in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area. Course syllabi document alignment and incorporation of both Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards. Courses focus on assessment, curriculum development, instructional planning, and the use of technology aligns with Arkansas teaching standards and educator competencies. Specific examples include Learning Theory (CIED 52203), Teaching Secondary Science (SEED 50103), and Assessment of Students with Disabilities (SPED 44503). These courses focus on key areas such as understanding student learning processes, applying effective science instruction methods, and assessing students with disabilities. Additionally, courses like Curriculum Development and Instructional Planning (SPED 44303) and Technology for the Inclusive Classroom (SPED 44203) ensure that candidates are equipped to develop and implement standards-based instruction for diverse learners, preparing them to meet the competencies required for their licensure area.

Course Instructor focus group participants shared that the multi-course literacy sequence was previously designed by aligning the ATS throughout coursework and is currently being revised using the standards for realignment. Five out of six participants provided specific examples of how their courses integrate ATS and Educator Competencies. For example, candidates in the Foundations of Literacy course are required to complete a one-on-one phoneme assessment, demonstrating their proficiency in Literacy Competencies.

Reviewers noted the use of competencies and standards in four of five observations. In Curriculum Design and Applications of Instructional Practice (CIED 41403), the review team observed instructors who co-taught and modeled best teaching practices aligned with Arkansas Educator Competencies and ATS. For example, instructors scaffolded new content with prior schema and used a variety of teaching strategies (individual think time, turn-and-talks, video). In another course, reviewers noted that CEC Initial Standards were evident through class discussion. DESE Inclusive Practices were also evident through modeling and reference to skills used in the general education classroom as well as DESE Inclusive Scenarios through scenarios utilized by the instructor during the lesson.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. Field experiences are aligned over time as evidenced in the “Summary of Field Experiences.” The “Revised Secondary MAT Program Handbook” includes a practicum field experience taken alongside appropriate coursework. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the connections between their coursework and fieldwork. For example, in the CHED MAT program, seminar courses such as CIED 4003 for B.S.E. students and CIED 5003 for MAT students, are conducted by the Clinical Supervisor in collaboration with the partnership school. These seminars provide a dedicated space for discussing internship expectations, coursework, and aligning theory with effective teaching practices in the internship setting. Interns are required to attend the seminar, which serves as a critical component of the program’s connection to clinical experience. Additionally, the Action Research project serves as a culmination of their coursework and internship, allowing them to apply and integrate knowledge and skills acquired throughout their academic experience.

Feedback from faculty, school partners, and students, collected through surveys, further supports the continuous alignment of field experiences with coursework.

The feedback from teacher candidates and mentor teachers is generally positive and reflects a strong preference for the current program structure. Feedback also highlighted the importance of continued collaboration between the university, mentor teachers, and candidates. Coursework focus group participants provided examples of specific courses that are tied to field experiences including Emerging Adolescents, Foundations of Literacy, and Integrated Social Studies. One candidate shared, "In Emerging Adolescents, we learn about brain function of adolescents and how students develop, and then we go into classrooms and see real-world examples." ELEL participants cited opportunities to spend the first 30 minutes of coursework discussing observations and tying that into practice, confirming they have opportunities to reflect on their alignment with instructors.

Reviewers also saw evidence of this alignment in course observations. In Curriculum Design and Applications of Instructional Practice (CIED 41403), instructors noted aloud that the course was designed to connect prior course content to current and future applications in the field. The instructors mention the candidate lesson plan template and specify it is designed to scaffold their thought process. Instructors acknowledged the difficulty of balancing student-teaching with coursework and consistently provided opportunities for candidates to share field experience connections to current content.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. The faculty roster provided evidence of terminal degrees, licensure, training in HQIM, and relevant professional learning. Most faculty have teaching experience and are trained in the Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

100% of Coursework focus group participants agreed instructors demonstrate deep knowledge of their content. For example, participants were aware of instructor credentials and professional experience including additional courses taught and experience in K-12 education. One participant said, "they (the instructors) practice what they teach. (They are) not just lecturing for three hours, they have us up working in groups, and they are helping us."

In the Course instructors focus group, participants provided specific examples of related professional development including national conferences, Arkansas Co-op provided training, and Arkansas IDEAS. In addition, participants cited peer learning through co-teaching, Cognitive Coaching, and alumni guest speakers.

In four of four coursework observations, reviewers noted evidence of course instructor knowledge. In Action Research (CIED 50703), the instructor integrated appropriate academic vocabulary when discussing statistical significance. For example, the instructor provided clear and explicit definitions of t-tests, null hypothesis, and p-values to determine statistical significance. In Disciplinary and Interdisciplinary Literacies in Education (SEED 40603), the instructor exhibited pedagogical content knowledge by explaining how to approach controversial topics through ethical analysis, referencing specific frameworks (Toulmin, 1958; Bybee et al., 2008) that support teaching argumentation and critical thinking. He modeled how to present multiple perspectives on issues like environmental conservation versus development, demonstrating sophisticated pedagogical approaches for handling complex content.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. Course evaluations document high averages (4.4 or above for all programs on a one to five scale) showing course instructors' history of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. Survey items address feedback, content, and engagement. However, survey results were in reference to courses and not instructors, and there was no evidence provided of an evaluation process for faculty that is specific to the EPP.

All participants in the Coursework focus group referenced examples of effective practices demonstrated by instructors. In addition, participants noted high-quality support and feedback from instructors saying, "the professor is very specific about how you word things and what verbs you use and whether it's application or understanding and how to reword 'I can' statements."

In four of five course observations, reviewers noted strong facilitation and feedback from course instructors. In Teaching Apparel Production (CATE 48103), observers saw small group differentiated instruction and peer teaching integrated frequently through the lesson. Additionally, the instructor integrated active participation and metacognitive formative assessment questions.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. The “UARK Residency Handbook” and the document “Sequence of Clinical Experience” outline the sequence of clinical experiences and requirements for each program prior to the final residency. All programs require early field experience prior to the final residency. The culminating field experience hour requirement varies across programs, but all programs require candidates to gradually take over full teaching responsibilities.

Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group described their clinical experiences. Across all licensure areas, candidates begin with initial observations and gradually take on more teaching duties, providing ample opportunities for learning and development. Candidates across all programs expressed that the progression feels “natural, supportive, and appropriately challenging.” An elementary candidate in their junior year said, “Before last fall, I was intimidated, but observations and co-teaching have made me feel better and I feel ready to teach in my own classroom next year.”

Participants in the Clinical Supervisor focus group reinforced UA’s intentional sequencing. Clinical supervisors shared that Elementary and Special Education place students first in rural settings with small groups, then in suburban settings with whole group instruction. Secondary education begins with 25 hours of hands-on tutoring and increases to 50 hours in junior high or high school placements and culminates in the senior year internship in both small and large schools. MAT candidates start with summer cohort, progress to 10–12 weekly hours in junior high settings, and advance to full-time teaching. Programs intentionally vary placements between rural, suburban, and diverse settings to provide comprehensive experiences that gradually increase teaching responsibilities.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. The provided evidence “How Placements are Categorized” describes UA’s system of defining district and school placements, noting that their Razorback Educator Development Hub manages over 1000 placements each academic year and includes a “List of Placement Schools Spreadsheet.” The EPP stated that candidates are required to visit multiple districts and grade levels throughout their grade band.

Clinical Experience focus group participants across all programs consistently report exposure to different classroom environments, including inclusion classrooms, which allows them to develop differentiation strategies and responsive teaching approaches. All five candidates agreed that from their perspective, field placements are intentionally designed to expose candidates to multiple student populations, ensuring they develop the skills necessary to meet the needs of all learners in their future classrooms. Through these varied experiences, most candidates gain first-hand knowledge of supporting students with IEPs, 504 plans, and English Language Learners. A candidate in the CTE program highlighted how their preparation in assessment courses translated directly to supporting students with varied learning needs in their placements, noting how strategies designed for learners with IEPs and 504 plans ultimately benefited all students. Candidates across programs did express a need for more structured support from the EPP on foundational knowledge to support special education students.

All six Clinical Supervisors also spoke about opportunities to work with multiple student populations saying that all programs expose candidates to different grade levels, geographic locations, and student populations to ensure comprehensive preparation for teaching. Programs intentionally create placements that allow candidates to

experience classroom environments with diverse learning needs, including English language learners, special education students, and varying socioeconomic contexts.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate they have the coaching skills to properly support candidates. The EPP provided a list of mentors used in the most recent academic year, including the mentor's qualifications, completion of coaching training (15%), national board certification and master or lead teacher (15%) designation. The EPP also noted that candidates survey mentor teachers at the end of every internship and provide feedback on mentor teachers. Survey results were provided for six programs. In three of the six programs, 100% of candidates strongly agreed or agreed with each question asked about their mentor's knowledge, support and effectiveness. In the other three programs, 80% or more of respondents agreed or strongly agreed with each question about their mentor.

Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group participants shared how they support teacher candidates. One participant said, "We have professional development that our district offers throughout the school year. We also look for additional opportunities that align with our program. We also meet with our departments for additional training."

Teacher candidates described their mentor teachers as "phenomenal," noting they explain their thinking, remain available for questions, and gradually release responsibility while ensuring candidates feel welcomed and respected as co-teachers in the classroom.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria. The EPP provided the "List of Placement Schools Spreadsheet" and a link to the "UARK Residency Handbook" pointing specifically to pages that describe the requirements for mentor teachers, selection of and expectations for mentor teachers. The EPP described providing school administrators with the criteria for effective mentor teachers, including three years of teaching experience and a score of "effective" or higher on TESS evaluations. Administrators approve or decline placements and suggest alternatives as they work with teachers in the building through this process. The EPP seeks faculty input on selecting mentors as well. Clinical supervisors communicate expectations directly to mentor teachers and interns.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. Clinical supervisors attend TESS training to ensure consistency in evaluations and meet regularly to identify struggling residents and develop support strategies. Supervisors maintain regular communication with residents to provide coaching and professional development suggestions. Survey data from mentor teachers shows that at least 85% of mentor teachers agree that "The university liaison/supervisor I worked with encouraged open and frequent communication from me."

Reviewers saw evidence of strong coaching in observations. In an elementary observation, reviewers noted, "The university supervisor referenced past observations and glows and grows from those experiences in scaffolding the candidate in this observation. The university supervisor asked good leading or prompting questions to engage the candidates in reflecting on her development Across multiple semesters and in her performance relative to this observation."

In another observation, reviewers noted that the university supervisor stated "Going back and looking at the Domains, you were addressing each of the domains. In Domain 2 - Respect and Rapport - you did very well interacting with

students and they interacted well with you. You honored them as mathematical thinkers and set the classroom as a culture of mathematical thinkers.”

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high quality feedback that is aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. The EPP detailed the expectation that university supervisors provide comprehensive feedback to interns through a structured process that includes pre-observation conferences, observations with written feedback, and post-observation discussions (POP) aligned with the ATR rubric. POP cycles in the fall inform interns' professional growth plans, which are developed collaboratively with mentor teachers and clinical supervisors. The feedback system offers targeted support as interns track their own progress toward self-selected goals for instructional improvement. This structured approach ensures interns receive both formative and summative assessments that foster their development as educators. The EPP provided pop cycle templates with pre- and post-observation questions, as well as templates or forms for supervisors to use when offering feedback.

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group reported receiving specific and actionable feedback that builds upon previous guidance to support their growth as a teacher. Feedback is consistently connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric with clear "glows and grows." Mentor teachers provide weekly feedback and complete two summative evaluations based on observations in addition to the one observation that university completes. One mentor teacher said, "We also talk every day about the lesson and reflect on what they did, and what they would do differently. Candidates are reflecting on what they should have done differently like pacing and how they can improve the next day."

Reviewers observed evidence of strong feedback in their coaching observations. In one observation, the clinical supervisor had the candidate focus on reflecting on how the flow worked during the group activity. The candidate reported that she felt that she was able to get to all the groups on time and stated "I would have worried about that more if my mentor teacher was not also helping me. If I was doing it alone, I am not sure I would have done it as a vertical activity." The clinical supervisor gave suggestions for how to make improvements for the next lesson as part of their conversation. Written feedback was provided using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

EXCEEDS

Collaborative processes are in place with school districts to co-construct the clinical experience. Participants in the Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group shared how they work closely with clinical supervisors. "We have a meeting every week with clinical supervisors. I can also contact (the supervisor) if we have additional questions." Another participant said, "Our university supervisor does a good job of reading those bi-weekly journals and supporting interns with an activity that helps them in class."

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric. The EPP regularly gathers feedback from school partners, including mentor teachers and school administrators, as seen in the "CHED MAT School Partner Field Experience Reflection." The EPP also partners with schools through the University Teacher Education Board (UTEB) to provide guidance on program changes, with meeting agendas available in the approved UTEB meeting minutes. In the "UTEB Meeting Minutes" agenda from November 2024 highlighted a discussion about mentor teachers needing to be trained in a coaching program and how to work together to ensure there are enough trained mentor teachers by 2027.

Additionally, the EPP hosts formal meetings twice a year with experienced mentor teachers and administrators to address major initiatives. In the February 2024 meeting agenda, partners engaged in discussion about the yearlong internship, Aspiring Teacher Permits and mentor teachers. Clear collaboration between UA and partner schools exists to improve the clinical experience for candidates.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place to support and develop effective clinical supervisors. Clinical supervisors regularly meet to receive training and calibrate on how to evaluate and provide actionable feedback to candidates, as seen in the “CHED TESS Calibration Spring 2021.” The Teacher Education Coordinator monitors training on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, HQIM, and SOR. Recently, elementary program instructors participated in a grant-funded initiative with Deans for Impact to integrate HQIM modules in science of reading courses. For 2024–2025, EPP clinical supervisors and experienced mentor teachers are focused on attending recognized coaching training, such as Cognitive Coaching.

Clinical supervisors confirmed they receive coaching and support. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants said they receive ongoing professional development. “We engage in regular professional learning opportunities including program meetings focused on identifying challenges and developing solutions.” They shared that they participate in state and national association training to enhance their knowledge and skills in supporting candidates. Supervisors actively participate in school-based professional development alongside mentor teachers, allowing them to stay current with K–12 instructional practices. This engagement with partner schools ensures supervisors understand current classroom challenges and can provide relevant guidance to candidates.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. Across all programs, the average GPA at admittance is 3.5 and at completion is 3.69.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their progress is off track. Faculty members can initiate a Notification of Concern (NOC). Once initiated, the candidate must meet with the faculty who submitted the notice to develop a plan for support. The NOC plan is a document that outlines the specific concern and details the action plan and next steps.

100% of Clinical Supervisor focus group participants agreed that the Notice of Concern (NOC) process provided candidate support. The NOC process is accessible to all faculty and district partners to file when there is a candidate concern. Participants explained that candidates meet with faculty for a Level 1 or 2 NOC and appear before the Teaching Professional Review Committee at Level 3. At all levels of the NOC an individualized support plan is created.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates’ clinical internships. The “Quality Assurance System” outlines requirements and expectations as candidates move through the program, which includes admission to the program, program retention, internship, exit from program, post exit licensure, and post exit follow-up. Most candidates meet clinical experience goals and milestones as evidenced by Aspiring Teacher Rubric Summative scores and graduation completion rates.

Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group demonstrated awareness of the specific requirements, observations, and evaluations that structure their clinical experience. They shared milestones include a gradual release of responsibility during their internship, formative and summative evaluations, and regular reflective assignments that help candidates track their progress. Secondary program candidates described specific culminating projects, such as independently teaching a unit plan, that serve as significant milestones in demonstrating their readiness to assume professional teaching responsibilities.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is some evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. Through the Impact on P-12 Learner's project and the Individualized Learning Plan Project Assessment (ILPPA), candidates are required to design learning goals with pre- and post-assessments and analyze the data to make instructional decisions.

Clinical Supervisors gave multiple examples on how the EPP prepares candidates to impact student growth. One participant said, "Candidates learn to collect, analyze, and respond to student performance data, demonstrating their ability to positively influence K-12 student learning outcomes. The programs help candidates develop a growth mindset about student learning." Candidates learn to analyze formative assessments and implement appropriate interventions based on student performance patterns, moving beyond simply collecting data to meaningful analysis and response. Candidates receive guidance on creating assessments that authentically measure student understanding and provide actionable data, with supervisors challenging them to consider "what are you going to do with it to prepare for your next lesson?"

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group talked about implementing various formative assessment strategies including project-based assessments, questioning techniques, think-pair-share activities, and confidence ratings on sticky notes to gather immediate feedback on student learning. Most of the examples that candidates gave included student data discussions with mentor teachers.

In three of the four coaching observations, reviewers saw evidence of formal assessments including a pre-assessment, homework assignment and preparation for a quiz. In two of the four post-observations discussions, reviewers noted some discussions of student assessment between the supervisor and candidate.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive a score of effective on the TESS rubric. The All EPP Tess Summative Spring data shows that across all programs, candidates are at or above the benchmark for each domain.

Note: By 2024-25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided with the support they need. Through the Notification of Concern process, faculty can flag when there is a concern with a candidate's clinical internship which initiates a meeting and support plan. The Razorback Educator Development Hub is a university center that supports candidates with requirements to complete early field experiences, internships and licensure, in addition to the support candidates receive from their supervisor and mentor teacher.

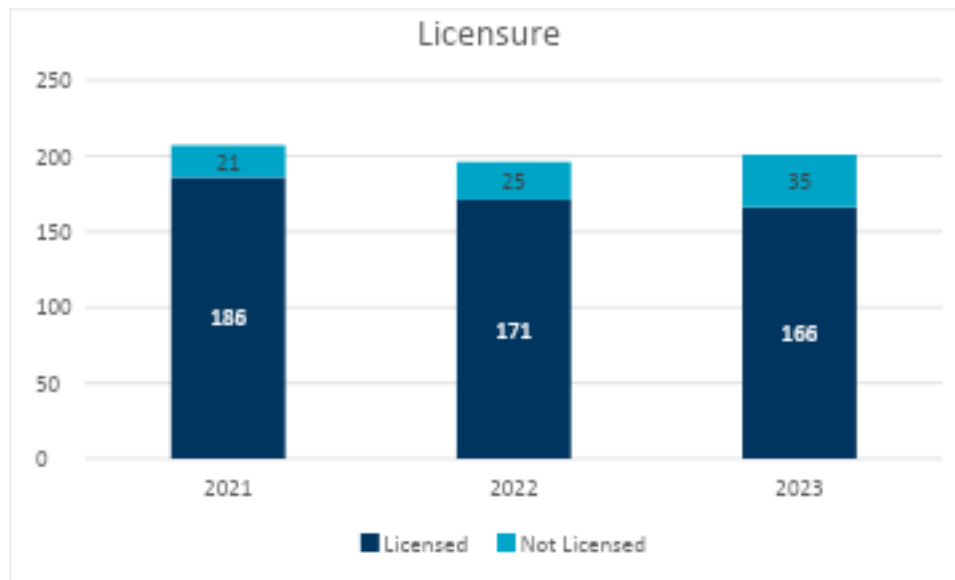
High performing candidates are recognized at UA through a variety of programs. UA's Honors College recognizes candidates who take a certain number of hours in an honors course and maintain high grades – giving them access to special housing and honors projects. Scholarships are part of the program, and they can publish their Honors Thesis, as well as graduate with the Honors distinction. Candidates are also eligible for various scholarships specifically created for teacher candidates who demonstrate a high level of academic achievement and leadership. Each year, UA recognizes outstanding students in each of the teacher programs. Finally, there are two student organizations for which high achieving candidates are eligible based on their leadership and academic excellence.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
EXCEEDS	BELOW	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Although a high proportion of program completers are employed in Arkansas schools, a low proportion of completers are working in high-priority districts and subjects. Pursue initiatives to encourage candidates to consider high-priority subject areas and work placements once licensed. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 3.2a, 3.2b</i>) - Continue to review EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3b</i>)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion	80%	87%	EXCEEDS

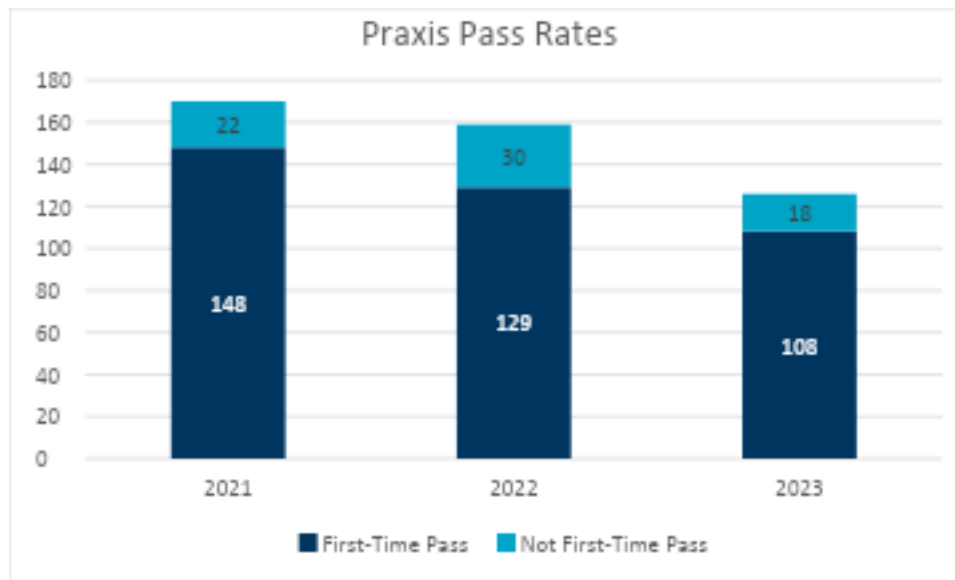


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	n/a	n/a

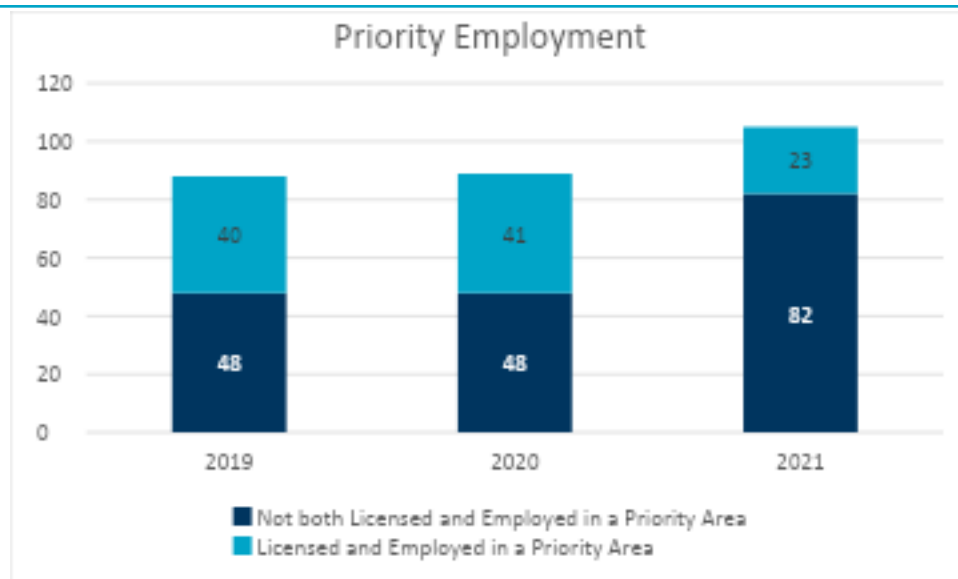
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	84.6%	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	46.3%	BELOW												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not both Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>88</td><td>102</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>89</td><td>123</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>105</td><td>102</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not both Licensed and Employed	2019	88	102	2020	89	123	2021	105	102
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not both Licensed and Employed													
2019	88	102													
2020	89	123													
2021	105	102													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	17.1%	BELOW												



*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

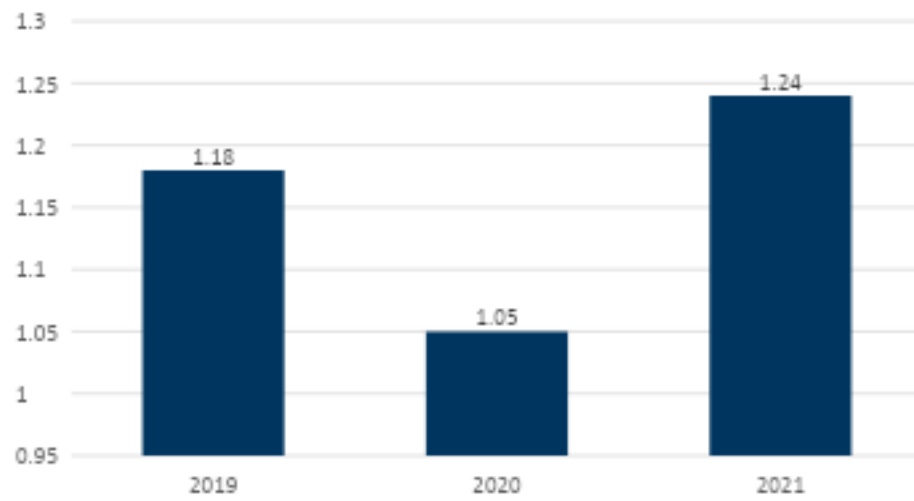
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	1.16	APPROACHING

Average Experience 3 Years After Completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	84.1%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	68.2%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	59%	EXCEEDS

